A Renegotiated Split, Applied Late, With No Record of Either Rate

Prepared for CFO Music Partners. Fictional example, published synthetic fixture.

The problem

Royalty and recoupment work stands or falls on history: which rate was in force on which date, and which events were applied against which balance. In a spreadsheet, a renegotiated split is usually handled by overwriting the old number. The old value is gone. Months later, a routine artist question becomes a forensic exercise, because nobody can show which rate produced a given line.

In the published synthetic fixture (a fictional 12-artist label, 40 tracks, $219,518.20 in synthetic quarterly gross), one artist's share on four tracks moved from 50 percent to 60 percent effective August 15. Applied one monthly period late, from September 1, the change misdirected $414.11 to the label instead of the artist, in the 17 days from August 15 to August 31 alone.

What an audit would ask	Spreadsheet answer
Which rate applied on August 20?	Unknown; the cell was overwritten
Which lines used the old rate?	Reconstruct from payment dates
What is the correction?	A manual restatement
Who approved the change, and when?	An email thread, if it survives

The $414.11 is 10 percent of $4,141.10, the revenue those four tracks earned in the 17-day window. The figure scales with the size of the change and the revenue in the gap, across every renegotiation, option pickup, and rate escalator in a catalog.

The same example in RevRule

In RevRule, an amendment adds a new version of the rule with its own effective date. The old version stays on record. Every revenue event is computed under the version in force on the event's date, and the hash-chained ledger records the rule version behind every line.

Question	RevRule answer
Which rate applied on August 20?	Version 2, 60 percent, effective August 15
Which lines used each rate?	A ledger query by event, participant, or entry type
What is the correction?	The $414.11 difference, identified with its cause
Can history be rewritten later?	No; a new version never rewrites settled events

The full ledger is returnable as JSON, simulation previews a renegotiation before it governs a live run, and in the fixture all 40 graph ledgers passed hash-chain verification. For a finance practice, the correction becomes a query instead of a reconstruction, and an audit starts from a record instead of a rebuild.

RevRule does not hold funds, execute payments, or collect royalties. It is the contractual accounting layer for money already collected.

Full product details: https://payloadhq.github.io/revrule.html